

Bangladesh: Rahman's rightward reshuffle will contain Jamaat's political rise

送信者: EG South Asia 受信日時: 2026-09-03 00:23

[【メール原文】](#)

Rahman signals right-of-center shift through cabinet reshuffle. Prime Minister Tarique Rahman's government is taking a more conservative stance to den||||||||||||||

Bangladesh

[Customize Email Preferences](#)

Rahman's reshuffle aims to contain Jamaat

2 Sep 2026 11:22 EDT [Discover more on the Portal](#)

*

Prime Minister Tarique Rahman will keep the right-wing Jamaat-e-Islami party at bay as long as the Iran conflict doesn't drag Bangladesh's economy into a deeper downturn.

*

Rahman's reshuffle creates a complicated three-minister foreign affairs structure, with policy coherence and reconciliation with India likely to suffer.

*

The Boeing purchase will protect Bangladesh's trade deal with the US, and a second reshuffle targeting the economic ministries is likely within weeks.

Rahman signals right-of-center shift through cabinet reshuffle. Prime Minister Tarique Rahman's government is taking a more conservative stance to deny the opposition Islamic party, Jamaat-e-Islami, any political mileage from the negative economic fallout of the Iran conflict. The move is largely preemptive: Rahman has been in power for barely half a year, his parliamentary majority remains solid, and Jamaat has struggled to position itself as a genuine alternative.

At least one liberal-leaning minister, Information and Broadcasting Minister Zahir Uddin Swapan, is leaving his post, though he remains part of Rahman's advisory team. Rahman also retained Foreign Minister Khalilur Rahman, who has taken a hard line with New Delhi over the extradition and trial of former prime minister Sheikh Hasina.

Bangladesh's three-minister foreign affairs structure will produce policy gridlock and freeze reconciliation with India. It was originally expected that Foreign Minister Rahman would cede his seat to the prime minister's foreign policy adviser, Humaiun Kobir, when the former left to take up the presidency of the UN General Assembly. Instead, the prime minister chose to retain the foreign minister even while he works in New York City for the next year. Kobir, though a junior minister, will become the de facto foreign minister during this period. As minister of state Shama Obaed Islam will also be retained, the result is a three-minister foreign affairs structure tailor-made to create gridlock. The foreign minister plans to set up a nine-person "camp office" in New York and fly back to Dhaka regularly.

Any reconciliation with India is unlikely for the next several months. New Delhi likely shrugged off Prime Minister Rahman's decision not to attend the BRICS summit later this month; Rahman has also not responded to India's earlier, open-ended invitation for a bilateral visit. So long as Bangladesh limits itself to rhetoric, India is prepared to wait until domestic equations change. New Delhi does not view the Rahman government as intrinsically hostile.

The reshuffle paves the way for a Boeing purchase that will safeguard the US trade deal. Prime Minister Rahman had implicitly promised to purchase 25 Boeing airliners as part of a bilateral trade agreement with the US, along with imports of US natural gas. The outgoing civil aviation minister, Afroza Khanam, had raised objections to the promise, citing legal issues with an earlier Airbus agreement and questioning whether Bangladesh's state-owned and private airlines could absorb such large purchases. Khanam's replacement by her junior minister was quickly followed by state-owned airline Biman announcing a \$3.7 billion, 14-plane Boeing purchase, and a supportive social media post by US Special Envoy for South and Central Asia Sergio Gor.

The Rahman government's claim that the announcement was not driven by US pressure is being met with skepticism. The deal is designed to ensure the continuation of the bilateral trade agreement with the US, the country's second-largest market for apparel and textile exports. The US has imposed an additional 10% tariff under its new forced labor import rules, but Bangladesh's effective rate of 25.6% remains lower than that of key competitors China and Vietnam. Another reshuffle in the coming weeks may bring changes to the economic ministries, including the commerce portfolio.

Pramit Chaudhuri
Practice Head, South Asia
chaudhuri.ne@eurasiagroup.net
Rahul Bhatia
Analyst, South Asia
bhatia.ne@eurasiagroup.net
EG South Asia
southasia@eurasiagroup.net

© 2026 Eurasia Group. All rights reserved. This material was produced by Eurasia Group for use by the recipient. This is intended as general background research and is not intended to constitute advice on any particular commercial investment or trade matter or issue and should not be relied upon for such purposes. It is not to be made available to any person other than the recipient. No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means, electronic or otherwise, without the prior consent of Eurasia Group.

X-HG-DocID cmtk6spz9dpci07mw7n55q4hi

Opt Out | Customize Email Preferences